

cc: Taylor, DuBois, Luxford, Olsen, Fox, Schmidt.

COPY

AMERICAN JEWISH CONGRESS

330 West 42d Street

New York City

Office of Dr. Wise

40 West 68 Street

May 3, 1943.

Hon. Sumner Welles

State Department

Washington, D. C.

Dear Secretary Welles:

You were good enough to forward to me a cabled report of Dr. Riegner, the representative of the World Jewish Congress in Geneva. In this report, he gave the following information:

"Provided necessary funds are available broad relief activity is likewise possible for Rumania, particularly Transnistria. It could be undertaken directly or through the Red Cross. Benvenis, Fildermann, and Wilhelm Fischer have been proposed by the Jews of Rumania to form a special commission which is strictly controlled by the authorities as the working nucleus of the Jewish central organization. Transnistria has appealed most urgently to us in the last few days for 1000,000,000 lei. The orphans and children who are to be transferred to Palestine will make the greatest demand on these funds (about 60,000,000 lei) for necessary equipment and clothing. If definite guarantee could be given that the amount would be placed at the disposition of America or Switzerland and reimbursement made after the war, the transfer of funds to Rumania would not be necessary.

"Large amount for France especially for rescued children who are being lodged at Suez (camp?) or hidden is also urgently needed as well as assisting the clandestine departure of youths who are trying to escape to North Africa or the Iberian Peninsula. Plans of this nature require large sums although no currency will be transferred to French territory. Sums are needed and will be used for concealment and departure of certain numbers of political friends who are endangered in France, as deportations there are constant."

According